

On becoming an expert on displays

They're everywhere. From the moment you open your eyes up to the time you fall asleep, it's very unlikely there'll be any moment when there isn't a display panel in front of your eyes. It could be your phone, the digital thermometer, the time indicator at the train station, your TV, your computer, your e-reader or your watch. According to one research study, we Indians spend an average of 96 minutes a day in front of the TV, another 95 minutes in front of our computers followed by 193 minutes of checking out our phones and tablets. That's six and a half hours each day! So how much do you really know about these screens which eat up more than 25 per cent of your life?

Each gadget sports a panel that's best suited for its purpose and there's a long winded story behind each of them. But we aren't going to prattle on about the history of displays throughout the entire issue, we're only giving you a primer before delving into the inner workings of the current generation of display technologies. You'll learn how LCD (Liquid Crystal Display) is actually an umbrella term for over 20 different display technologies that have been evolving since the early '70s. How panel manufacturers retain a monopolistic hold over their technologies. Once you go through these pages you'll understand which panel is suited for what kind of purposes – a gamer would prefer a TN panel while a professional designer will prefer IPS over VA any day, and your run-of-the-mill VA panel is a jack of all trades. How the rule of convergence applies here as well.

It's not just monitors and television panels that we're looking at, even the latest 3D head mounted displays have been covered. We explain the state of current tech out there in this domain and what's available if you want to